Maria Thurn

+45 71 58 91 18 | 2500 Copenhagen | mail@mariathurn.de | LinkedIn | GitHub | mariathurn.de



Designer & Developer — Web, Mobile & Interactive Applications

PERSONAL PROFILE

I am a graphic designer who learned to code. With a BA in Design and an MSc in IT & Cognition from the University of Copenhagen, I build interactive applications for the web, mobile and game engines using React, React Native, TypeScript, C# and Unity. My background in design and human-computer interaction means I care about how people actually use a product, something I saw first-hand while supporting app customers at Mercedes-Benz and building VR product experiences for Siemens Healthineers.

I enjoy working at the point where design meets code: turning ideas and prototypes into polished, working products, together with designers, developers and product people.

EDUCATION

University of Copenhagen
08/2024 – 07/2026
Master of Science in IT and Cognition
Focus on HCI, ML and NLP; courses incl. Frameworks and Architectures for the Web.
Thesis: Cross-lingual Representation and Explainability of Named Entities, fine-tuning and evaluating multilingual Transformer models (XLM-R, mT5) in PyTorch. GitHub

Maastricht University
02/2022 – 07/2024
Bachelor of Liberal Arts and Sciences, University College Maastricht
Specialisation in Psychology and Neuroscience, incl. human physiology; strong research skills.

Maastricht University
10/2020 – 07/2021
BSc Data Science and Artificial Intelligence (56 ECTS completed)
Java, data structures & algorithms, software engineering; transferred to Liberal Arts and Sciences.

TH Nuremberg
10/2015 – 03/2020
Bachelor of Arts in Design
Main subjects: 3D, Photography, Typography; foundations in interaction design.

EMPLOYMENT HISTORY

University of Copenhagen
09/2025 – 01/2026
Programming Teaching Assistant
- Mentored students in scientific Python programming, adapting explanations to each level.

Mercedes-Benz CSC
08/2021 – 02/2023
Customer Service Representative – Technical Support
- Provided technical support to international customers by phone and email, troubleshooting issues with mobile apps and in-car systems.
- Handled a high daily volume of enquiries, building a strong sense for usability pain points.

Siemens Healthineers
08/2019 – 03/2020
3D Visualisation Designer
- Designed and built a full-scale VR exhibition hall for medical technology products in 3ds Max and supported testing of the experience.

Adidas, Herzogenaurach
08/2017 – 02/2018
3D Design Intern, Digital Creation
- Created 3D footwear prototypes and evaluated new digital tools for designers' workflows.

PERSONAL PROJECT

- **Danish learning app (in development):** Cross-platform vocabulary app built with React Native and Expo.

SELECTED COMPETENCIES

Web & Mobile: React, React Native (Expo), TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, REST APIs, Git
Games & Other: C#, Unity, Python, Java
Design & UX: UX/UI and interaction design, prototyping, user-centred design, Photoshop, Blender, 3ds Max
Data & AI: Machine Learning, NLP, PyTorch, Hugging Face Transformers, NumPy, Pandas

LANGUAGES & ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Languages: Danish (Intermediate), German (Native), English (Professional), Japanese (Beginner)
- Volunteer at IDCN (International Dual Career Network), organising events for international professionals.
- Designer of tabletop card games, play-tested regularly at community gaming cafés.